

SOME SHARKS GROW UP TO 30,000 TEETH IN THEIR LIFETIME



Freshwater sharks

Some shark species are found in freshwater habitats. The bull shark, for example, lives in warm coastal waters worldwide, but it sometimes swims up larger rivers and into lakes. Bull sharks are very territorial, so if they find humans swimming in their river, they may attack them.

Mississippi River

One bull shark reached Alton, Illinois, 1,150 miles (1,850 km) upstream.

Potomac River

Bull sharks up to 8 ft (2.4 m) long have been caught in the Potomac.

Lake Nicaragua

Bull sharks reach the lake via the San Juan River.

Amazon River

There have been sightings of bull sharks 1,200 miles (2,000 km) from the sea.



Nicole

In 2003–04, a female great white shark, nicknamed Nicole, made the longest known migration by a shark. Nicole swam from Africa to Australia and back—more than 12,400 miles (20,000 km)—in 9 months. She mostly swam at the surface, but at times she reached depths of up to 3,200 ft (980 m).



Nicole's route was tracked using an electronic tag fitted to her fin.

DISTRIBUTION OF SHARKS WORLDWIDE

Some shark species cruise almost all the world's oceans, while others have a more limited range, preferring either cooler or warmer seas.



Whale shark

The largest fish in the sea, reaching lengths of 40 ft (12 m) or more, the whale shark prefers warm waters. It feeds mainly on plankton.



Basking shark

At 30 ft (10 m) long, this is the second-largest fish. Found in temperate seas, it swims open-mouthed, filtering plankton from the water.



Great white shark

Found in the majority of the world's seas, the great white has made the most recorded attacks on humans. It can swim at more than 25 mph (40 kph).



Great hammerhead shark

Often found near tropical reefs, the great hammerhead preys on stingrays, using its hammer to pin down the fish before biting them.



Port Jackson shark

A reef-dweller from around southern Australia, this shark has wide, flat teeth that crush hard-shelled prey such as oysters, snails, and crabs.



Pygmy shark

At 8–10 in (20–25 cm) long, this is one of the smallest sharks. It hunts squid at depths of up to 6,000 ft (1,800 m) in subtropical and temperate seas.